Smart Weekly Meal Planner – Prototype Summary

1. User Persona
Name: Rahul Sharma
Age: 29
Profession: Software Engineer
Rahul works long hours and usually reaches home late in the evening. He prefers eating home cooked food but rarely plans his meals in advance. Most evenings he ends up spending several minutes trying to decide what to cook, or simply orders food online because it feels easier.

Goals
- Eat healthier meals at home
- Save time deciding what to cook
- Avoid unnecessary grocery purchases

Pain Points
- Meal planning feels time consuming
- Hard to remember what ingredients are already in the kitchen
- Lack of simple tools that suggest meals based on available time

2. Problem Statement
Many busy professionals want to cook at home but struggle to plan meals during the week. Because planning takes time and requires thinking about ingredients, recipes, and grocery shopping, people often delay the decision until the last moment. This leads to wasted ingredients, unnecessary grocery purchases, or ordering food instead of cooking.

Mapped User Flows

1. Setting Up Preferences

This flow captures how a new user begins using the product and provides basic information needed for personalization.

Steps:

1. The user opens the Smart Weekly Meal Planner.
2. The user clicks on **Start Planning**.
3. The user selects their **dietary preference** (vegetarian, vegan, non-vegetarian, etc.).
4. The user chooses the **amount of time available for cooking** (15 minutes, 30 minutes, or 45+ minutes).
5. The user enters **ingredients already available in their kitchen**.
6. The user clicks **Generate Meal Plan**.
7. The system creates a personalized weekly meal plan based on the inputs.

Outcome:
The user receives a suggested weekly meal plan tailored to their preferences and available ingredients.

2. Generating a Weekly Meal Plan

This flow shows how users quickly create a plan for the entire week.
Steps:

1. The user provides their cooking preferences and available ingredients.
2. The system analyzes the information.
3. A **weekly meal plan from Monday to Sunday** is generated.
4. Each day shows a suggested meal along with cooking time.

5. The user can review the suggested meals.

Outcome:
The user now has a structured meal plan for the week.

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3. Swapping a Meal

This flow allows users to modify the meal plan if they prefer different options.

Steps:

1. The user views the weekly meal plan.
2. The user clicks **Swap Meal** on a particular day.
3. The system displays a list of alternative meal suggestions.
4. The user selects a preferred replacement.
5. The weekly plan updates automatically.

Outcome:
The meal plan becomes more flexible and personalized.

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4. Generating a Grocery List

This flow helps users prepare for the week by identifying missing ingredients.

Steps:

1. After finalizing the weekly meal plan, the user selects **Generate Grocery List**.

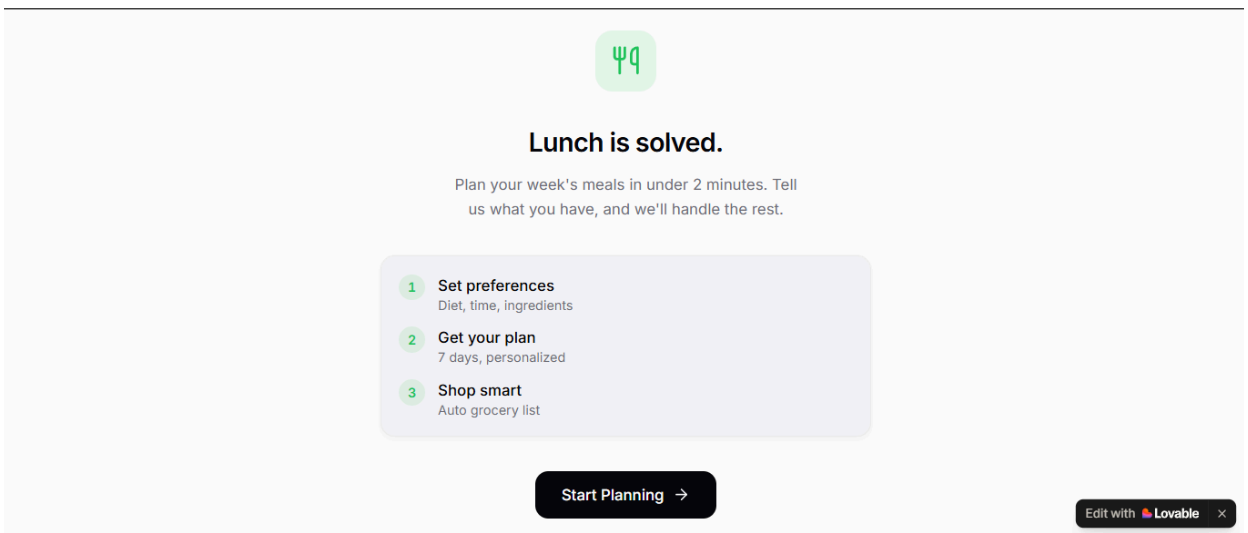
2. The system compares recipe requirements with ingredients already available.

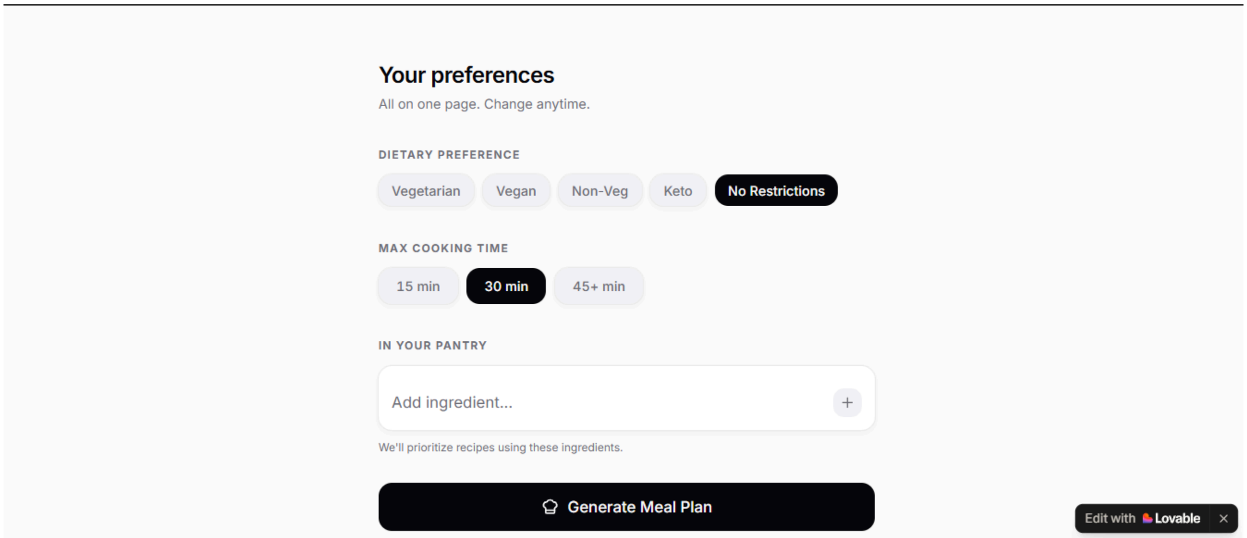
3. Missing ingredients are added to a shopping list.

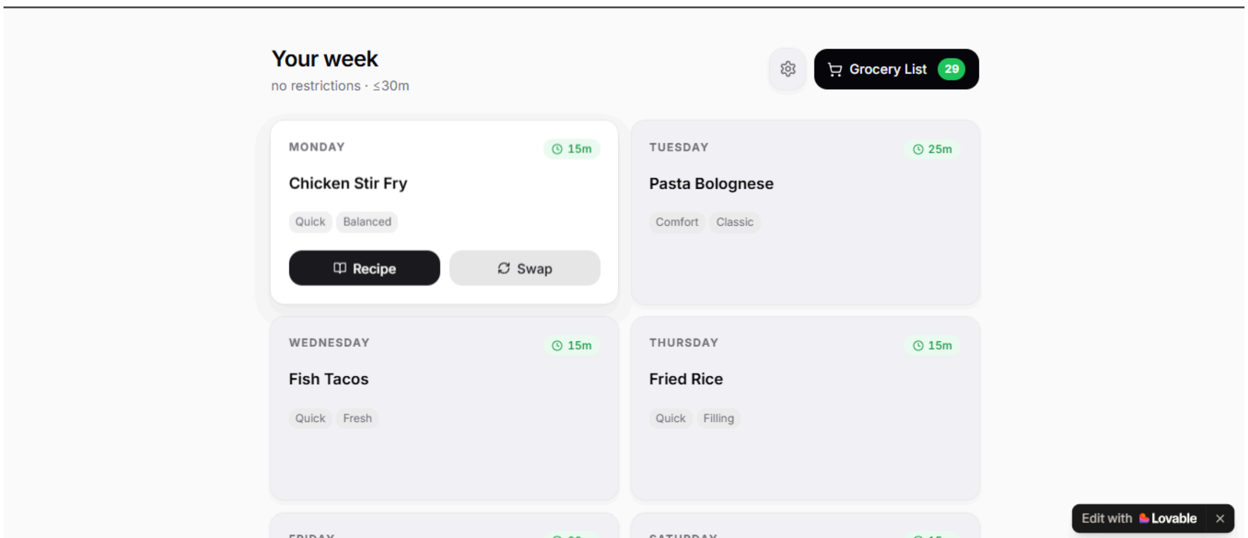
4. The user can **copy or download the grocery list**.

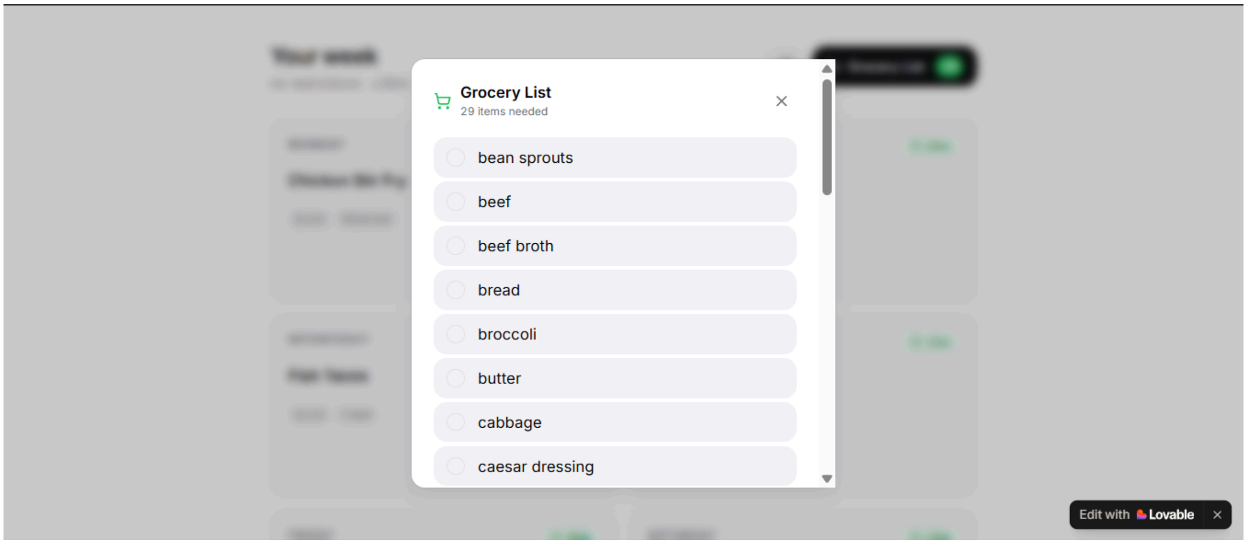
Outcome:
The user gets a clear list of items needed for the week's meals.

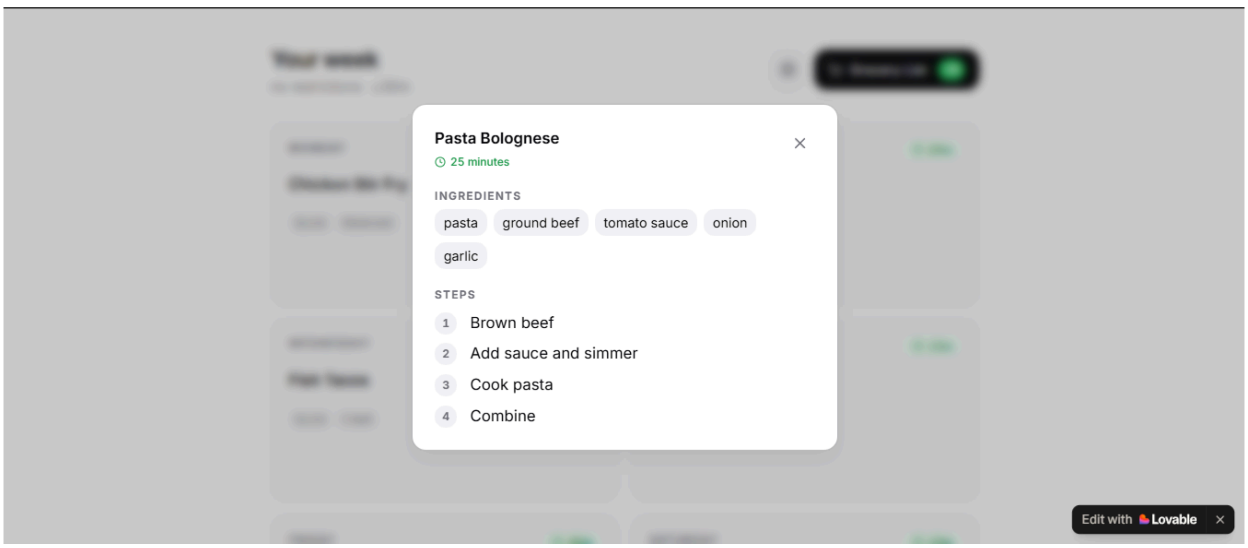
Screenshots.




Your preferences
All on one page. Change anytime.
DIETARY PREFERENCE
Vegetarian
Vegan
Non-Veg
Keto
No Restrictions
MAX COOKING TIME
15 min
30 min
45+ min
IN YOUR PANTRY
Add ingredient...
We'll prioritize recipes using these ingredients.
Generate Meal Plan
Edit with Lovable


Your week
no restrictions · ≤30m
Grocery List 29
MONDAY
15m
Chicken Stir Fry
Quick
Balanced
Recipe
Swap
TUESDAY
25m
Pasta Bolognese
Comfort
Classic
WEDNESDAY
15m
Fish Tacos
Quick
Fresh
THURSDAY
15m
Fried Rice
Quick
Filling
Edit with Lovable





Summary of Feedback & Refinements

To understand how useful the prototype would be in real-life scenarios, I shared the meal planning tool with a few users who regularly cook at home but have limited time during the week. The goal was to observe how easily they could create a weekly meal plan and identify any friction in the process.

Key Feedback

1. Users wanted flexibility in meal suggestions
Some users mentioned that they might not always like the first suggested meal. They preferred having the ability to quickly swap meals with alternative options.

2. Ingredient-based suggestions were important
A few users highlighted that they often forget what ingredients they already have in their kitchen. They found the idea of generating meals based on available ingredients very helpful for reducing food waste.

3. Grocery planning was a useful addition
Users liked the idea of automatically generating a grocery list after finalizing the weekly plan. This made the tool feel more practical and easier to integrate into their weekly routine.

Refinements Made

Based on the feedback received, the following improvements were incorporated into the prototype:

- A **Swap Meal feature** was added to allow users to easily replace suggested meals.

- The system was updated to **prioritize meals that use ingredients already available in the kitchen**.

- An **automatic grocery list generator** was included to help users quickly identify missing ingredients needed for the week.

These changes helped make the tool more flexible, practical, and aligned with real user needs.

Loveable Link:
https://meal-spark-pro.lovable.app/